

A full-page background image of badminton player An Se-young in action. She is wearing a white t-shirt with orange accents and a blue skirt, both featuring the 'P.LAB' logo. She is holding a badminton racket high in her right hand, looking upwards with a focused expression. The background is a blurred blue stadium.

AN SE-YOUNG

BADMINTON

Reigning Olympic champion An Se-young set a new benchmark for women's badminton with an astonishing 2025 season. The 23-year-old Korean won 11 titles — the Malaysia Open, India Open, Orléans Masters, All England Open, Indonesia Open, Japan Open, China Masters, Denmark Open, French Open, Australian Open and the BWF World Tour Finals.

With these 11 titles, she broke her own record of nine titles in a season from 2023 and matched Japan's Kento Momota's all-time record from 2019 to become the most successful singles player in a season.

She also helped Korea reach the final of the Sudirman Cup, a biennial mixed team tournament, but her side lost 1-3 to China.

With her speed, sharp reflexes and overall court craft, the former world champion dominated her opponents throughout the year, finishing with a staggering win-loss record of 73-4 (a win percentage of 94.80). Only Japan's Akane Yamaguchi and China's Chen Yu Fei (twice) and Han Yue could beat the Korean in 2025.

An also became the first badminton player to earn over USD 1 million in prize money in a single season.

Nihit Sachdeva